

User Guide

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Based on the app and website archives supplied for this documentation update. Source descriptions include implementation limits and should be reviewed when code changes.

Start here: choose your protection

Geaux combines an on-device DNS filter (Geauxhole) with a WireGuard client. You can use either service independently or enable both. This guide describes the supplied source snapshot dated 14 September 2026.

First connection

Open Configure > DNS Settings and confirm the selected resolver. The default configuration selects Cloudflare DoH and includes Quad9 as another saved resolver. Open Dashboard and enable Geauxhole. Accept the iOS VPN configuration permission if prompted, wait for the connection status, then open a website and inspect Traffic.

Geauxhole	WireGuard	What happens
Off	Off	Protection is stopped.
On	Off	DNS-only: selected system DNS goes to the local filter; ordinary application traffic uses the normal connection.
Off	On	WireGuard-only: profile routes apply; Geauxhole rules and Smart Cache are not used.
On	On	Combined: intercepted DNS is filtered locally; other captured traffic goes to WireGuard.

Add WireGuard

Obtain a valid single-peer configuration from your VPN provider or server administrator. In Configure > WireGuard Profiles, create a profile, import from Clipboard or enter the fields, save it, and select it as active. Enable WireGuard on Dashboard. Leave Geauxhole enabled if you want filtering too.

Routing scope matters

AllowedIPs determines which IP destinations enter WireGuard. A profile containing 0.0.0.0/0 and ::/0 requests both IPv4 and IPv6 default routes. A narrower profile is split routing: do not assume every connection is protected. DNS-only mode cannot capture arbitrary hardcoded DNS destinations.

Check success

Confirm the Dashboard switches and connection status, then test actual browsing. A VPN icon or connected label alone does not prove the resolver or remote WireGuard server is reachable.

Source: DashboardView.swift; GeauxCore/GeauxConfig.swift; GeauxExtension/PacketTunnelProvider.swift: applyNetworkSettings

Find your way around

The four main areas separate connection controls, recent activity, configuration, and device preferences.

Area	Use it for
Dashboard	Turn Geauxhole and WireGuard on or off, select the active WireGuard profile, and inspect request and blocking totals.
Traffic	Search and filter recent records, open grouped request details, and create rules from a domain.
Configure	Custom Rules, Bypass Domains, Blocklists, DNS Settings, WireGuard Profiles, Advanced WireGuard, and the raw configuration editor.
Settings	General preferences, appearance, Diagnostics, Known Bugs, About, and Danger Zone.

Saving and applying

Many switches save automatically. Editors and Advanced WireGuard have a Save action. Rule edits may show a processing/synchronization overlay: wait for completion. A displayed configuration error means the requested update may not be active.

Changes during a connection

Ordinary rule and DNS policy updates use a configuration reload. Mode, active WireGuard profile, profile fields, or pacing changes can rebuild the WireGuard engine and interrupt traffic briefly. Changing the anon-relay bypass list clears the DNS cache and resets the resolver without rebuilding the WireGuard tunnel.

Appearance

Settings > Appearance offers Orange (default, #FF5E00), Purple (#8E399C), and Olive (#454B1B). The choice updates secondary accents, tree artwork, and the Home Screen icon where supported. iOS may show an icon-change notice. Appearance is stored separately from network configuration and does not change filtering.

Default starting point

Defaults in this snapshot are DNS-only routing, Force DNS Rewrite off, a one-hour TTL cap, High-Entropy Domains off, Hide Local Discovery on, and System Logging off. Existing saved configurations can differ.

Source: ContentView.swift; ConfigurationView.swift; SettingsView.swift; Theme.swift; GeauxCore/GeauxConfig.swift; GeauxExtension/PacketTunnelProvider.swift: handleAppMessage

Rules, bypasses, and blocklists

Use the smallest matching scope that fixes the problem. Filtering bypass and anon-relay bypass solve different problems.

Control	Meaning and interaction
Custom Rules	Assign Allow, Reject, Reject Drop, or Reject No Drop to an exact domain or domain family. An Allow match skips the entropy heuristic, but still uses the normal DNS resolver path.
Bypass Domains	Override DNS filtering for a matching domain. DNS resolution still occurs; this does not create an IP route around WireGuard.
Anon Relay Bypass	Keep DNSCrypt encryption but skip its relay for a domain and its subdomains. Filtering still applies. Configure under DNS Settings when an active DNSCrypt relay is in use.
Blocklists	Download supported domain lists and apply the selected action to enabled subscriptions. Disabled subscriptions are not active rules.

Exact versus subdomains

example.com is exact. *.example.com and ||example.com^ represent the domain family, including example.com itself and its subdomains. Do not paste a full URL or path. For example, bypassing example.com alone will not bypass ads.example.com; choose family scope when needed.

What block actions do

Reject and Reject No Drop currently both produce an NXDOMAIN-style DNS block reply when the reply fits the implementation buffer. Their recorded action labels remain different. Reject Drop sends no reply, so an app may wait or retry. Allow continues resolution; it is not a guarantee that the upstream will answer.

Set up a subscription

Open Configure > Blocklists, paste a text-list URL, choose Matching action, and tap Add Blocklist. The initial default is <https://small.oisd.nl> with Reject No Drop. The add form initially selects Reject. Tap a subscription to edit it, or use its switch to enable or disable it.

Refresh frequency and formats

Choose Daily, Every 2 Days, Every 5 Days, Weekly, or Custom days. The default interval is one day; iOS lifecycle and app activity affect actual update opportunities. Supported input includes domain lines, wildcard/domain-family entries, and common hosts-file lines. This is not a complete browser Adblock engine: exception syntax (@@), URL paths, and \$ modifiers are unsupported.

Source: CustomRulesView.swift; BypassDomainsView.swift; DomainBlocklistsView.swift; DNSSettingsView.swift; GeauxCore/DomainRuleCanonicalizer.swift; geaux-rust/src/lib.rs

Encrypted DNS and anon relays

Configure > DNS Settings selects the resolver that Geauxhole uses for allowed intercepted queries. Saved servers are choices; the code selects one active server rather than racing the whole list.

DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH)

Add a descriptive name, select DNS-over-HTTPS, and enter the provider's HTTPS DNS endpoint. Save and select the server. A plain HTTP URL is not accepted. The resolver must return DNS wire-format responses; an ordinary website URL is not a DNS endpoint.

DNSCrypt

Add a resolver with Protocol set to DNSCrypt and paste its resolver stamp. A stamp describes the DNSCrypt endpoint and identity. Use the resolver's actual stamp, not a DoH URL. Save and select the server.

Anonymized Routing

For DNSCrypt, enable Anonymized Routing and supply a compatible relay stamp. The relay forwards encrypted DNS to the resolver. This changes the DNS transport path; it is not an anonymity guarantee for the whole device. The resolver and relay must both be reachable.

Relay compatibility exceptions

The default relay-bypass domains are mzstatic.com, itunes.apple.com, apps.apple.com, cdn-apple.com, and aaplimg.com. They include subdomains. Add, edit, or remove exceptions in Anon Relay Bypass, or use Bypass Anon Relay from a Traffic detail. These queries go directly to the DNSCrypt resolver, so that resolver can see the direct source address.

Situation	Try this
Only a particular service fails with a relay	Test that domain with a relay bypass, then retry. Keep a filtering bypass separate unless the Traffic record shows a block.
All DNSCrypt queries fail	Check both stamps and test the resolver without its relay to isolate the failing path.
A DoH server fails	Check the complete HTTPS endpoint and select another configured resolver for comparison.
Both protection switches are on	Geauxhole still uses its selected encrypted resolver. Do not assume these resolver connections are carried inside WireGuard.

Connection changes

After changing resolver or relay endpoints, reconnect if behavior remains unchanged. Some endpoint route exclusions are installed when network settings are applied; a DNS-only hot reload does not necessarily reapply those routes.

Source: DNSSettingsView.swift; GeauxCore/DoHResolver.swift; GeauxCore/DNSCryptResolver.swift; GeauxExtension/PacketTunnelProvider.swift: getActiveResolver, applyNetworkSettings, handleAppMessage

DNS protection and Smart Cache

These controls affect intercepted DNS, not every encrypted name lookup made by every app.

Setting	Purpose	Interaction
Force DNS Rewrite	Default off. Intended to capture hardcoded plaintext DNS on port 53 within the tunnel.	Unavailable in DNS-only mode. Combined mode redirects captured UDP DNS to Geauxhole. WireGuard-only is intended to rewrite toward profile DNS; see the technical implementation note before relying on it.
TTL Cap	Maximum fresh local cache lifetime. Default 1 Hour.	Off, 1 Minute, 15 Minutes, 1 Hour, 12 Hours, or 24 Hours. A shorter authoritative TTL still wins.
Clear Smart Cache	Remove cached DNS responses and invalidate pending generation work.	Useful after DNS changes or troubleshooting. Does not clear Traffic history or blocklists.

Example: a cap is not a forced lifetime

If the resolver returns a 60-second TTL and the cap is one hour, the answer remains fresh for at most 60 seconds. If the resolver returns two hours and the cap is one hour, fresh lifetime is capped at one hour. Off bypasses cache reads and storage.

Fresh and stale answers

A fresh hit avoids another upstream lookup. Eligible positive answers can be served stale for up to 15 minutes after fresh expiry while a background refresh runs. Stale replies use a short 30-second record TTL. Negative answers and answers marked authenticated by the upstream are not eligible for this stale path. A stale label does not itself mean the connection failed.

Limits of interception

Force DNS Rewrite does not decrypt app-owned DoH or DoT. The intercepted DNS path is UDP-based. DNS-over-TCP and fragmented DNS that must be intercepted are dropped rather than forwarded around policy. Very large answers may require TCP and therefore fail for affected clients.

WireGuard-only caution

The setting is exposed for WireGuard-only, but this snapshot's packet-processing path does not populate the UDP parse data in that mode. Treat hardcoded DNS rewrite there as unverified and do not depend on it for enforcement; the technical guide traces the gap.

Source: DNSSettingsView.swift; GeauxCore/ThreadSafeLRUCache.swift; GeauxCore/DNSMessageValidator.swift; GeauxExtension/PacketTunnelProvider.swift: readPackets, processPacket, resolveAndCache

WireGuard profiles and performance

Configure > WireGuard Profiles stores connection profiles. Select an active profile before enabling WireGuard. Imported configurations must contain exactly one Peer section.

Field	Purpose / guidance
Name	A label to distinguish profiles.
Private Key / Peer Public Key	Your client identity and the remote peer identity. Use the exact Base64 keys from the provider; each decodes to 32 bytes.
Preshared Key	Optional extra shared secret; it must match the peer.
Addresses	Client IPv4 and/or IPv6 CIDR addresses assigned by the server.
Endpoint / Port	Remote hostname or IP and its UDP port. Bracket IPv6 endpoints in imported config text.
AllowedIPs	CIDR routes carried by this peer. Both default routes are needed for IPv4 and IPv6 full routing.
DNS	Profile DNS IP addresses used in WireGuard-only mode. They must be reachable through the intended route and have a compatible address family.
Keepalive / Listen Port	Optional periodic peer traffic and local UDP port. Keep the provider's values unless you need to change them.
Automatic MTU / MTU	Automatic uses a fixed 1280 bytes. Manual MTU accepts 1280-4096; larger values can cause path-size problems.

Advanced WireGuard

Speed Limit defaults to 400 Mbps (50,000,000 bytes/s). Choices are Disabled, 100, 200, 300, 400, or 800 Mbps. Instant Burst defaults to 2 MB, with 4 or 5 MB alternatives. Waiting Room defaults to 1,024 packets, with 512 available. Tap Save to apply.

How pacing settings interact

The speed limit sets sustained pacing, the burst lets short transfers proceed immediately, and the waiting room bounds queued packets. Larger queues can add latency and memory pressure. Disabled removes pacing but retains other bounded queue protections. Burst and waiting-room pickers are disabled when pacing is off. Reset Performance Defaults changes the editor values; Save commits them.

Source: WireGuardSettingsView.swift; WireGuardProfileListView.swift; AdvancedWireGuardSettingsView.swift; GeauxCore/GeauxConfig.swift; geaux-rust/src/wireguard.rs

Traffic, preferences, and diagnostics

Traffic records explain the app's observed decisions. They are bounded activity records, not a complete packet capture or proof that every connection succeeded.

Read a grouped record

Search for a domain, open its detail, and inspect individual DNS types. A asks for IPv4 addresses; AAAA asks for IPv6 addresses. A group can have a successful A answer and a failed AAAA answer. PARTIAL DNS RESPONSE means at least one type resolved; it does not promise every part of the service will work.

Understand failures

DNS FAILURE and SERVFAIL can be accompanied by a typed reason: upstream SERVFAIL, refusal, timeout, malformed or mismatched response, transport failure, overload, or temporary retry suppression. A single AAAA failure does not identify its cause. Use the recorded reason and compare another resolver.

Take action from Traffic

Block Domain creates a blocking rule; Bypass Domain creates a filtering exception; Bypass Anon Relay, when available, changes relay routing. Choose exact or family scope carefully. Fresh Cache and Stale Cache distinguish cache paths from an upstream resolution.

Preference	Default / effect
Connect On-Demand	Asks iOS to maintain the selected connection on Wi-Fi and cellular. This is separate from the saved DNS/rule configuration.
High-Entropy Domains	Off. Blocks sufficiently random-looking unmatched domain names. It is a heuristic and can block legitimate services. A specific allow or bypass can resolve a false positive.
Hide Local Discovery	On. Suppresses relevant records, and intercepted .local or _dns-sd queries can receive REFUSED without upstream resolution. Turn it off to investigate local service discovery problems.
System Logging	Off. Settings > Diagnostics enables bounded operational logging. More logging can affect battery use. Runtime counters can still be exported with logging off.

Export diagnostics

Open Settings > Diagnostics > Export Diagnostic Logs. Reproduce the issue first, then export and inspect the report before sharing. Note the mode, resolver, relay use, and whether the issue happened on Wi-Fi, cellular, or after waking.

Source: TrafficMonitorView.swift; TrafficViewModel.swift; GeneralSettingsView.swift; DiagnosticsView.swift; GeauxCore/DNSFailureReason.swift; GeauxExtension/PacketTunnelProvider.swift: processPacket

Troubleshooting and maintenance

Change one setting at a time and retest the same failing action. This makes it easier to distinguish filtering, DNS transport, and WireGuard problems.

Symptom	Next steps
A website is blocked	Find its Traffic entry and matched rule. Add the narrowest filtering bypass or correct the custom rule. Clear Smart Cache if needed, then retry.
Browsing fails only with WireGuard	Check the active profile, endpoint, keys, AllowedIPs, and address families. Try Automatic MTU. Compare Geauxhole-only operation.
Failure after Wi-Fi/cellular switch	Allow reconnection to settle, test browsing, and compare Dashboard with iOS VPN state. Reconnect if necessary; collect diagnostics if repeatable.
Repeated partial DNS responses	Inspect the failed type and typed reason. Compare resolver/relay choices rather than treating the whole group as a block.
Unexpected local-device failures	Temporarily disable Hide Local Discovery and retry. Also check whether the WireGuard routes capture your local network.
Rules appear unchanged	Wait for processing to finish and check configuration warnings. Disabled entries do not apply; an exact domain does not cover its children.

Clear Statistics

Settings > Danger Zone > Clear Statistics removes aggregate counts. It explicitly leaves logs and settings. It is not a history-erasure control.

Reset All Settings

The other Danger Zone action removes custom configuration, blocklists, WireGuard profiles, and preferences and restores defaults. Keep original WireGuard configuration files securely if you will need them again. The normal raw config stores Keychain references rather than portable private keys.

What leaves the device

Filtering decisions and traffic storage are local. Allowed DNS queries go to the selected DNS service; lists are downloaded from their configured URLs; WireGuard traffic goes to the configured peer. Relay-bypassed DNSCrypt queries omit the relay. These services have their own visibility into traffic.

Support

Use the website's existing Contact & Support section for the developer's email and issue tracker. Include a minimal reproduction and diagnostic export when useful. This documentation was checked against source; it does not represent an on-device network certification.

Source: DangerZoneView.swift; RawConfigEditorView.swift; GeauxCore/GeauxConfig.swift; GeauxCore/WireGuardSecretStore.swift; DiagnosticsView.swift